

Teaching portfolio

Nick Ford

Department of Economics

Faculty of Business and Social Sciences

Teaching philosophy

I believe teaching should:

- 1) develop students' capacity for critical thinking
- 2) connect academic ideas to real-world societal challenges.

My goal is to help students move from memorising facts to evaluating evidence, questioning assumptions, and applying economic reasoning to problems that matter beyond the classroom.

I teach by meeting students at their level, and by combining clear, research-based explanation with active, applied learning. Lectures establish core concepts and frameworks; in-class exercises, case discussions, and short projects give students opportunities to practise analysis and test ideas. I use real-world examples, contemporary policy questions, and empirical data to make content relevant. A particular approach I have found effective is to design exercises and exam tasks that employ hypothetical scenarios, and require students to evaluate trade-offs and make recommendations, rather than simply calculating outcomes. This encourages them to think critically about the implications of different choices and to consider the broader context in which economic decisions are made.

I favour this approach because critical thinking and societal relevance reinforce one another: by encouraging students to think beyond the textbook, they are better able to evaluate policy and real-world trade-offs. Connecting theory to practice also demonstrates the relevance of economic concepts.

I assess outcomes most directly through student evaluations, but also by inviting feedback directly from students during the semester. Across key evaluation metrics, students demonstrate high levels of satisfaction with my courses, and I have received positive comments about the clarity of my explanations and the relevance of course content. I also reflect on student performance in assignments and exams to identify areas where students may be struggling, and I adjust my teaching accordingly.

Teaching experience

Year(s)	Institution	Subject	Level	ECTS	Language	Role
2025–26	SDU	International economics	Bachelor	10	Danish	Course convenor
2026	SDU	International economics 2	Bachelor	5	English	Course convenor
2025	SDU	International economics 1	Bachelor	5	English	Course convenor
2025	SDU	Perspectives on economic behaviour	Bachelor	5	English	
2024	SDU (Sønderborg)	International economics	Bachelor	5	English	Inherited course mid-semester
2021–24	Lund University	Environmental history from an economic perspective	Bachelor	7.5	Swedish	
2022–23	Lund University	Research design, methods and data collection	Bachelor	7.5	English	Responsible for one of three modules
2022–23	Lund University	Human capital in a historical perspective	Master	7.5	English	
2019–20	SDU	Macroeconomic analysis	Bachelor	10	Danish	Teaching assistant
2019	SDU	Methods in dynamic economics	Bachelor	10	Danish	Teaching assistant
2008	Monash University	Principles of microeconomics	Bachelor	7.5	English	Teaching assistant

In addition to teaching courses, I supervise students completing bachelor and master's theses. At Lund University, I conducted econometrics labs for master's students, helping them to think through challenges associated with the empirical aspects of their thesis projects.

For the period 2022–2026, I also served as an external examiner (*censor*) for economics courses at Danish universities.

Pedagogical education

Lecturer Training Programme, SDU (summer 2025–26), including courses in:

- Assessment basics
- Managing group work